
Splettstoessers versus Reinhardts

History of Corrigan Property

Family History

1887 / Quedlinburg, Germany

Fritz and Minna Splettstoesser. For both it was their only marriage and they had ten children of which two died in infancy. On March 6th, 1935 information on all their children's names and spouses can be found [here](#).

Note: It's interesting this 1935 document indicates the two were married in 1887 because Minna Splettstoesser's Journey To America diary indicates Oct/Nov 1886 - a year before their 1887 marriage and with two boys Willy and Fritz. Also, EW Splettstoesser died at the age of 89 on April 3rd, 1968 per his probated will. This implies his birth year was around 1879 which is before 1887.

October 8th to November 12, 1886 / Journey To America

Mrs. Minna Splettstoesser immigrated to the United States with her two boys Willy and Fritz. They stopped in New York, but their final destination is Moscow, Texas (Polk County). Their travels also take them through Galveston and Houston, Texas. From her notes it appears that her husband Fritz already lives in Texas. Minna Splettstoesser's diary can be found [here](#).

June 21st, 1916

Willie Splettstoesser marries Frederica Reinhardt in Polk County, Texas. They have two daughters Louise (born April 19, 1917 and named after Frederica's mother) and Nina. Louise Splettstoesser married Vernon Madden and Nina Splettstoesser married Scat Sullivan. Willie and Frederica's marriage license can be viewed [here](#).

September 1915

Fritz Splettstoesser passes and without a will. Frederica Splettstoesser's father.

January 1924

Minna Splettstoesser passes. Frederica Splettstoesser's mother.

April 1968

E. W. Splettstoesser passes. His probated will can be viewed [here](#).

*** Date TBD ***

Frederica Splettstoesser passes.

*** Date TBD ***

Louise Madden passes.

Reinhardts vs. Splettstoessers

As with any family there can be disputes and the Reinhardts and Splettstoessers were not immune to this conflict. From what can be gathered, it centered around loans made from EW Splettstoesser to the the brothers of Frederica Reinhardt Splettstoesser (Willie and Julius), Reinhardt family conflict settling their parents estate and the elderly care of Frederica Reinhardt Splettstoesser's elderly parents. In 1938, and after some 15+ years, it culminated at the Polk County court house where a judge settled the dispute ultimately dividing the land of the Reinhardt family home amongst its four children (Willie, Julius, Frederica and Charles). In the end, it appears EW Splettstoesser was not happy at all with the outcome based on his lack of compensation for the money loaned to the Reinhardt brothers that was never repaid in full.

Unsigned summary agreement (date unknown) of dividing the old Reinhardt family homestead (137 acres in all; 121 acres in the WP Valentine survey and 16 acres in the JH Parsons survey) among the Reinhardt children (Willie, Julius, Frederica and Charles). The agreement can be viewed [here](#).

Unsigned Reinhardt and Splettstoesser settlement agreement (May 1937). Notice the handwriting on page 3 attempting to reconcile the money owed to EW Splettstoesser with land out of the Reinhardt estate. The agreement can be viewed [here](#).

May 1937: Reinhardt vs Splettstoesser Polk County Court Cause no. 6384, document 1 of 3, overseen by Judge ET Murphy. This document describes the legal description/metes and bounds of the Reinhardt family homestead (137 acres) to be divided amongst its heirs. It can be viewed [here](#).

May 1937: Reinhardt vs Splettstoesser Polk County Court Cause no. 6384, document 2 of 3, overseen by Judge ET Murphy. This document describes the individual tracts of land (i.e. share) to be granted to each of the Reinhardt children. It should also be noted the division is not solely on the amount of acreage, but its value per three previous independent appraisals. It can be viewed [here](#).

May 1937: Reinhardt vs Splettstoesser Polk County Court Cause no. 6384, document 3 of 3, overseen by Judge ET Murphy. This document is very similar to document #2, but also includes legal and other expenses due to others as well as a map showing the boundaries of the divided Reinhardt family homestead. It can be viewed [here](#).

May 1937: Map of the divided Reinhardt family homestead as included in document #3. It can be viewed [here](#).

April 18th, 1920

EWS loans Willie Reinhardt a total of \$2650 (about \$41,000 in today's dollars) and \$1000 to Julius Reinhardt (\$16,000 in today's dollars). This is one of many loans EWS makes with the Reinhardt family. From the letters of EWS it's apparent the money was never paid in full and was one of the major reasons for the conflict between the Reinhardt and Splettstoesser families. The actual loan notes can be viewed [here](#).

November 9, 1930

EWS letter to J.W. Cobb (Administrator of Reinhardt estate) summarizing outstanding loans he made with Fritz Reinhardt and the money owed to him from the Reinhardt estate. It can viewed [here](#).

December 25, 1933

EWS letter to Julius Reinhardt, explaining notes haven't been paid, EWS/Fred need cash to pay debts as there's not enough money to live on from his railroad salary. Offering to

forgo all interest owed, he just needs any cash Julius can pay toward his debt. It can viewed [here](#).

January 30, 1934

EWS letter to Willie Reinhardt, explaining notes haven't been paid, ask for new notes to give him more time to pay, offer to forgive one of the notes if Willie grants/deeds his interest in the old Reinhardt place to Fred. It can viewed [here](#).

November 11, 1934

EWS letter to attorney in Livingston (P.R. Rowe) and how his wife has been mistreated by her brothers Willie and Julius. P.R. Rowe handles legal matters for the Reinhardt executor JW Cobb. EWS points out that Willie Reinhardt was quick to get compensated for burial/etc. of his parents. EW and Fred cared/nursed her parents, paid all their expenses and didn't ask for one cent! Charlie Reinhardt is the only one acting honest. Mr. Cobb wants to be released as executor/administrator of Reinhardt estate. This is one more example of the conflict between the Reinhardt and Splettstoesser families. It can viewed [here](#).

December 3, 1934

EWS letter to local banker and friend C.C. Poole of the Corrigan Citizens State Bank. He mentions Mr. Cobb given up administration of Reinhardt estate and told the heirs to get along with what is left of the Reinhardt estate. EWS recognizes Fritz Reinhardt was not a deadbeat, but Willie and Julius still owe him thousands of dollars each. EWS is will to settle their debts/loans by doubling the appraised value for their share in Reinhardt homestead and deed it to Fred, so Charlie Reinhardt will have a home and everyone can move on. It can viewed [here](#).

February 2, 1935

EWS letter to an attorney, James Hill in Livingston, TX. With the passing of Fred's father, it was assumed the Reinhard estate would be in the hands of her mother Minna Reinhardt by silent consent and without any court proceedings. Minna knew her family and had a will drawn up by J.Y. Renfro and appointed J.W. Cobb to act as administrator. EWS was asked to be administrator, but he declined given the potential conflict of interest with outstanding loans of Willie and Julius Reinhardt. Minna Reinhardt knew her family and knew her brothers would try to beat her out of her share of the estate. EWS mentions the outstanding debts, but in the end has left it up to his wife Fred with any settlement of the Reinhardt family homestead. It can viewed [here](#).

February 12, 1935

EWS letter to the attorney P.R. Rowe in Livingston, TX. He sites the Reinhardt debt owed him and how the money was used to purchase the land they own today. He is quite angry calling Willie and Julius dead beats, cheats and hiding behind the statute of limitation to not repay him the loans. He wants Charlie Reinhardt to have a home and offered to settle the unpaid loans by doubling their appraised value in their share of the Reinhardt homestead so the land can be deeded to his wife Fred. It can viewed [here](#).

January 26, 1937

EWS letter to attorneys Crow & Chessher trying to get to a settlement before everything goes to court. He points out he's willing to receive land out of the Reinhardt homestead to settle the debt owed to him by *Fritz* Reinhardt and wants to ensure anything he receives is next to Fred's land. If not, he wants it adjoining the railroad right of way he

already owns. EWS says with regards to the debt owed to him by Willie and Julius Reinhardt, "As you can tell from the letters and notes I turned over to you, I am always willing, and anxious to meet anyone FAR more than halfway, but when they show that they are just out on the Deadbeat, and are not willing to do even half right, I certainly am reluctant to just let them swindle me out of still more, and then laugh at me for letting them get away with it". It can viewed [here](#).

June 6, 1937

EWS letter to Charlie Reinhardt. It's after the court case has been settled in May 1937 and reflects on everything. He says, "It is strange thing to me that the courts are so absolutely HELPLESS when it comes to dealing with a crook, and have such unlimited power when it comes to making an honest man pay". He discussed with Charlie the court costs for settling Reinhardt dispute and says it was a mistake mixing his dispute with Will/Julius/Fritz loans with Reinhardt homestead land division. Calls Julius/Willie Reinhardt crooks and how they wanted the best of the Reinhardt estate for themselves. It can viewed [here](#).

Corrigan Property Acquired and Granted To Others

January 28, 1938

Frederica Splettstoesser receives 44 acres as part of the court case to settle her parents estate with her brothers Willie, Julius and Charles. It spans the WP Valentine and JH Parsons surveys and is comprised of 40.5 and 3.5 acres respectively. The deed that conveys this property to Frederica is recorded in Polk County's public records Volume 113, Pages 57-60 and can be found [here](#).

July 19, 1938

E.W. Splettstoesser receives 14.98 acres of a railroad right of way from the Waco, Beaumont, Trinity & Sabine Railway Company. The property spans both the WP Valentine (12.38 acres) and JH Parsons (2.6 acres) surveys and is also adjacent and south of the 44 acres Frederica Splettstoesser received from the court case against her brothers Willie and Julius Reinhardt. The deed is record in Polk County's public records Volume 114, Pages 141-143 and can be viewed [here](#).

May 19, 1939

E.W. Splettstoesser sells his 2.6 acres out of his railroad right of way property to his wife's brother, Charles Reinhardt. The 2.6 acres is all in the JH Parsons survey leaving E.W. 12.38 acres in the WP Valentine survey. The deed is recorded in Polk County's public records Volume 122, Pages 413-414 and can be found [here](#).

April 3, 1968

E.W. Splettstoesser passed away at the age of 89. The probate of his will directs his property to his wife Frederica Splettstoesser. Because of this, the railroad right of way property (12.38 acres) was conveyed to his wife Frederica. His probated will can be viewed [here](#).

December 13, 1983

Frederica Splettstoesser grants 44 acres (40.5 acres in the WP Valentine survey and 3.5 acres in the JH Parsons survey) to her daughter Louise Madden. The deed is recorded in Polk County's public records Volume 449 Pages 91-93 and can be found [here](#). Note: I don't believe that Frederica Splettstoesser recognizes her ownership of the railroad right

of way property (12.38 acres). If she did, I believe it would have also been granted to Louise Madden. We will likely need to find Frederica's probated will to fully understand who technically owns the 12.38 acres. If Louise's sister Nina is also alive at their mother's passing, there's a chance both could own the 12.38 acres.

March 24, 1987

Louise Madden grants, in a general way and without any metes and bounds, all her property in the WP Valentine and JH Parsons survey. This implies the 44 acres she was granted from her mom on December 13, 1983, but doesn't explicitly reference the 12.38 acres of railroad right of way. The deed is recorded in Polk County's public records Volume 596 Pages 793-794 [here](#)

2024 Property Management

2024 Expenses

Forest Management Plan / 1-d-1 Application: \$1,500
Land Surveys: \$10,000
Land / Timber Appraisal: \$2,875
Attorney Consulting: \$100
Polk County Document Requests: \$72
2024 Property Taxes: \$104.44 (statements can be found [here](#))

Total: \$14,651.44 (divided by three is \$4,883.81 each and settled at closing)

Polk County Appraisal District updates and corrections

The three tracts of land (40.5, 3.5 and 12.38 acres) in Corrigan, Texas reside in Polk County and are under the jurisdiction of the Central Appraisal District (Polk CAD). It assesses the value of the land and timber for which annual property taxes are based.

In late February 2024 it was learned the Polk CAD requested an updated 1-d-1 Open-Space Timber Appraisal Application - correspondence can be found [here](#). Successfully completing and submitting the application would keep the existing timber exemption that reduces the property taxes by \$7500/year. Having no experience at all in what's required, a forester well versed in this area was hired. Joe Plueger with Lone Star Forestry visited the property and developed a Forest Management Plan. He submitted it along with the 1-d-1 application to the Polk CAD and the timber exemption was successfully retained. The Forest Management Plan can be found [here](#).

Based on 2024 activities, a number of Polk CAD updates and corrections were completed and are reflected on its web site found [here](#).

- Mailing address updated to Corky's home to receive future correspondence.
- Map location of the 3.5 acres corrected (this was erroneously located as the railroad right of way going to the McManus Creek).
- As a result of the updated survey, the 40.5 and 3.5 acres was combined into a single survey and its total acreage reduced to 32.457 acres. This also results in one versus two tax statements.
- As a result of the updated survey, the railroad right of way acreage was reduced from 12.38 to 11.603 acres.
- Ability to find the two new property IDs for 2025 and search by property owner "Madden" corrected.

The Corrigan Property had been passed down the generations and the last known survey was almost 100 years ago. To prepare the land to sell, and to remove any potential ambiguity in the location and amount of acreage, a Category 1A Land Title survey was ordered. Texas Professional Surveying (Conroe, TX) performed the work. As a result the following was learned:

- The 44 acres (40.5 acres in the WP Valentine survey and 3.5 acres in the JH Parsons survey) is actually 32.457 acres and resides in the A. Mardez survey and surveyed as one tract of land. Its survey can be found [here](#) and its metes and bounds found [here](#).
- The 12.38 acres (railroad right of way) was reduced to 11.603 acres and also resides in the A. Mardez survey. Its survey can be found [here](#) and its metes and bounds found [here](#).

Property and Timber Appraisal

An appraisal of the Corrigan land and timber was conducted in order to obtain an independent evaluation of its value and used to know if a buyer's offer is fair and reasonable. This work was performed by Harry Faulkner of Lufkin, Texas. The appraisal report can be found [here](#).

Family Pictures

Reinhardt Farm Home [picture](#).

Frederica Reinhardt (Age 15) [picture](#).

Frederica Reinhardt/Splettstoesser (young woman) [picture](#).

Poppie and Louise (Age 2) [picture](#).

Poppie Mommie Girls / Austin, TX [picture](#).

Louise Splettstoesser Portrait Photo (young woman) [picture](#).

Louise Splettstoesser / Miss Trinity 1933 (Age 16) [picture](#).

Estil Madden (Corky's grandfather), Maggie Gaitlin Madden (Corky's grandmother), Mommie Splettstoesser, Poppie Splettstoesser, Louise, Vernon, Diane and Michael (1944) [picture](#).

Mommie, Poppie, Thomas and John (1950s ?) [picture](#).

Mimi Louise (Age 77), Children, Great Grandchild 1993 [picture](#).

Misc Pictures

Corrigan Property / David Reed's Land / House [picture](#).

Corrigan Property / David Reed's Land / Shop - first pic [picture](#).

Corrigan Property / David Reed's Land / Shop - second pic [picture](#).

Corrigan Property / David Reed's Land / View of 44 Acres - first pic [picture](#).

Corrigan Property / David Reed's Land / View of 44 Acres - second pic [picture](#).

Trinity Property / Aunt Kittie Reinhardt (Julius' wife), Mimi Louise, Mickey [picture](#).

Trinity Property / Aunt Kittie Reinhardt (Julius' wife) and Mimi Louise [picture](#).